

Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

GLASSHOUSE

A MATTER OF DEGREE

Once it was pedigree, now it's about educational degrees. Political rivals have always questioned Prime Minister Narendra Modi's post-graduate degree despite a mention in his election affidavit. Delhi chief minister Arvind Kejriwal, an IIT graduate himself, is only the most recent to call him 12th-pass and even "illiterate". Meanwhile, the BJP isn't done with Rahul Gandhi. When sister Priyanka defended him after his Lok Sabha disqualification, saying the BJP called him Pappu even though he has degrees from Harvard and Cambridge, BJP IT cell head Amit Malviya was quick to ask for proof of the former since Rahul's affidavits don't mention it. Priyanka is partially correct. Rahul was at Harvard briefly, but earned his BA degree at Rollins College, Florida. His affidavit also mentions an M.Phil. degree from Trinity College, University of Cambridge.

State as Matchmaker?



They may exchange heated arguments as political adversaries but occasionally there is light-hearted banter too. As in the Maharashtra legislature recently when Maharashtra deputy chief minister **Devendra Fadnavis** said that the state government was willing to take responsibility for the marriage of Shiv Sena (Uddhav Balasaheb Thackeray) leader **Aaditya Thackeray,** the bachelor boy retorted with a smile: "Is this a *rajkiya dhamki* (threat of a political nature)?" The exchange left the house in splits.

SURPRISE SPREE

Raids or visits, the Gujarat government's conducting them with surprise. State home minister **Harsh Sanghavi** recently led a surprise raid on all the state's central and sub-jails. Personally supervising the operation from a control room through multiple CCTV cameras, the raid involving 1,700 cops resulted in the seizure of weapons, narcotics and cellphones. Earlier, CM Bhupendra Patel paid surprise visits to the villages in Mansa taluka near Gandhinagar, the slums of Vadodara, the Directorate of Pension & Provident Fund in Gandhinagar and the SP office in Ahmedabad Rural. Government officials are on high alert, not knowing when they'll be taken by surprise.



CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

Kaushik Deka with *Jumana Shah, Amitabh Srivastava, Dhaval Kulkarni* and *Amarnath K. Menon*



AIDE OF NO USE

Sign of things to come? TDP cadre has been feeling enthused after the party won four Andhra Pradesh Legislative Council seats and four MLAs of the ruling YSR Congress cross-voted. Chief Minister **Y.S. Jagan Mohan Reddy** may retain a firm grip on the party and government, but cracks are starting to appear. Many blame Sajjala Ramakrishna Reddy, the CM's political advisor, for bringing the party to this pass and want him removed. A one-man show so far, Reddy will finally have to contend with dissent.

Getting Filmy



As he rose to speak in the Bihar assembly on March 23, Bihar deputy chief minister **Tejashwi Yadav** drew a rather stretched analogy with the film *Karan Arjun* to take a dig at Prime Minister Narendra Modi. In the film, mother Durga's prayers are answered as her slain sons return in reincarnated avatars. And it was because "*Ganga maiyya ne bulaya hai*", the PM had said, that he contested from Varanasi. But Bihar too is situated on the Ganga, Yadav said. Has Ganga Maiyya stopped calling her son now? *Na beta aaya, na achhe din laya*, Yadav quipped, giving a glimpse of some of the wit he may have inherited from father Lalu Prasad.